Ardenfield Mutual

HOMES TODAY. STRONGER TOMORROW.

Homeowners Policy Wording

Applies to Homeowners Standard and Homeowners Plus

Edition	2026
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Products	Homeowners Standard, Homeowners Plus

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This policy wording, together with your schedule, forms your contract of insurance with Ardenfield Mutual. Please read it with your schedule. Words in **bold** have the meanings given in Section 2. Each clause is numbered, and we refer to clauses by their number, for example "§3.1".

SECTION 1

About this policy

1.1 **Our agreement with you.** This policy is a contract between you and Ardenfield Mutual. In return for your premium, we insure your **home** against the loss or damage described in this wording, during the **period of insurance** shown in your **schedule**. The contract is made up of this policy wording, your **schedule**, and any endorsement we send you in writing. If this wording and your **schedule** differ, your **schedule** applies.

1.2 **What this policy covers.** We cover your **dwelling** (Section A, set out in Sections 3 and 4) and your **contents** (Section B, set out in Section 8) against loss or damage caused by the insured perils, during the **period of insurance**. Section 9 sets out optional covers, which apply only if your **schedule** shows them. All cover is subject to the exclusions in Sections 4 and 11, the **deductible** in Section 5, the claims conditions in Section 6, the limits in Section 7 and the general conditions in Section 10.

1.3 **Products.** Homeowners Standard and Homeowners Plus cover the same insured perils. They differ in the **deductible** (Section 5) and in the limits shown in your **schedule** (Section 7). Optional covers (Section 9) can be added to either product.

1.4 **How to read this wording.** Each clause is written to be read on its own, so some information is repeated. Where a clause depends on another clause, it names it by number. A heading is there to help you find a clause; it does not change what the clause says. Examples in a clause show how it works; they are not a complete list.

1.5 **Your schedule.** Your **schedule** shows your name, the address of your **home**, your product, the **period of insurance**, your **dwelling limit**, your **contents limit**, your **deductible** and any optional covers. Please check it when you receive it and tell us straight away if anything is wrong. We rely on it when we deal with a claim.

1.6 **Renewal.** Before your **period of insurance** ends, we will write to you with the terms for the next year. If you want to renew, you do not need to do anything unless we ask you to. Each renewal starts a new **period of insurance**.

1.7 **About Ardenfield Mutual.** Ardenfield Mutual is a mutual insurer. Our policyholders are our members, so we have no shareholders. We insure homes and property, and we handle claims for water damage, storm, fire and theft.

SECTION 2

Definitions

These words have the same meaning wherever they appear in **bold** in this policy wording and in your **schedule**.

2.1 **We, us, our.** Ardenfield Mutual.

2.2 **You, your.** The person or people named as policyholder in the **schedule**, and members of their family who live with them permanently.

2.3 **Family.** Your husband, wife, civil partner or partner, your children, your parents and any other relative who lives with you permanently.

2.4 **Schedule.** The document that shows your product (Homeowners Standard or Homeowners Plus), the **period of insurance**, the address of your **home**, your **dwelling limit**, your **contents limit** and your **deductible**.

2.5 **Period of insurance.** The dates shown in the **schedule** during which this policy is in force.

2.6 **Home.** The private dwelling at the address shown in the **schedule**. It includes its fixtures and fittings, its **fixed water installations**, and its garages and outbuildings.

2.7 **Dwelling.** The structure of your **home**, including floors, walls, ceilings, fitted kitchens and bathrooms, and permanent fixtures and fittings. It also includes your **outbuildings**, patios, paths and drives, and the **underground services** that belong to your **home**.

2.8 **Outbuildings.** Garages, sheds, greenhouses and other permanent buildings within the boundary of your **home** that are not part of the main house.

2.9 **Contents.** Household goods and personal belongings that you own or are responsible for, kept in your **home**. For example, furniture, rugs, electrical goods and clothing. **Contents** include **valuables** and **money**. They do not include anything that is part of the **dwelling**, motor vehicles, caravans, boats, or property held for business.

2.10 **Fixed water installation.** Any fixed pipe, tank, radiator, boiler, cistern, bath, shower, sink or toilet in your **home**, and the pipes that connect them.

2.11 **Appliance.** A washing machine, dishwasher, fridge, freezer, water softener or similar domestic appliance connected to the water supply in your **home**, including its hoses and connections.

2.12 **Sudden and accidental.** Something that happens unexpectedly, at a single identifiable time, and was not intended by you.

2.13 **Escape of water.** Water escaping from a **fixed water installation** or an **appliance**.

2.14 **Gradual leakage.** Water leaking, dripping or seeping from any source over a period of 14 days or more, whether or not you were aware of it.

2.15 **Sealant and grouting.** The silicone, mastic, grout or other flexible or filled joint that keeps water inside a bath, shower, shower tray, sink, toilet or tiled surface.

2.16 **Wear and tear.** The gradual loss of condition that happens to everything with age and use, including rust, corrosion, rot, perishing and fading.

2.17 **Defective workmanship.** Work on your **home** that was carried out badly, or that used the wrong or faulty materials, or that was designed badly, whoever carried it out.

2.18 **Unoccupied.** Your **home** is unoccupied when nobody has lived in it, or slept in it overnight, for more than 60 days in a row.

2.19 **Deductible.** The amount you pay towards each claim, as set out in Section 5.

2.20 **Dwelling limit.** The most we will pay for any one claim for loss or damage to your **dwelling**, as shown in your **schedule**.

2.21 **Contents limit.** The most we will pay for any one claim for loss or damage to your **contents**, as shown in your **schedule**.

2.22 **Storm.** Wind of at least 90 km/h, or torrential rain, hail or snow, that causes damage to a number of properties in the area at about the same time.

2.23 **Flood.** Water from outside your **home** that rises or flows into it, for example from a river, a lake, the sea, a drain that has overflowed, or surface water after heavy rain.

2.24 **Subsidence.** The downward movement of the ground under your **home**, not caused by the weight of the building itself.

2.25 **Heave.** The upward movement of the ground under your **home**, for example because clay soil swells.

2.26 **Landslip.** The downward movement of sloping ground.

2.27 **Underground services.** The pipes and cables below ground that you are legally responsible for and that serve your **home**, running between your **home** and the public mains or sewer.

2.28 **Trace and access.** The work needed to find where water is escaping from, including lifting floors and opening walls, and the work to make good afterwards.

2.29 **Accidental damage.** Physical damage that happens suddenly and unexpectedly from an outside cause, and that was not intended by you.

2.30 **Valuables.** Jewellery, watches, items of gold, silver or other precious metal, precious stones, furs, pictures and other works of art, and collections of stamps, coins or medals.

2.31 **Money.** Cash, bank notes, cheques, postal orders, gift vouchers and prepaid cards, held for private use.

2.32 **Single article.** One item, or a pair or set of items that are normally used together.

2.33 **Pair or set.** Items that belong together and are of a similar design, colour or material, for example a three-piece suite, a pair of earrings, or a set of dining chairs.

2.34 **Personal possessions.** Clothing and personal items that you normally wear or carry, such as a mobile phone, glasses, a bag, a laptop or sports equipment, and **valuables** you carry.

2.35 **Emergency.** A situation where urgent action is needed to stop damage getting worse or to make your **home** safe, secure or fit to live in.

2.36 **Adjuster.** A person employed or appointed by us to assess a claim, inspect the damage and decide what we pay.

2.37 **Contractor.** A tradesperson or business that carries out repair work, such as a plumber, builder, electrician, flooring fitter or restoration specialist.

2.38 **Betterment.** The extent to which a repair or replacement leaves your property in a better condition, or of a higher value, than it was just before the loss or damage.

2.39 **Business use.** Any trade, profession or business carried on at your **home**, other than office work by you with no visitors or stock.

2.40 **Terrorism.** An act, including the use of force or violence, by any person or group, carried out for political, religious, ideological or similar purposes, including to influence a government or to put the public in fear.

SECTION 3

Buildings cover (Section A)

Sections 3 and 4 together make up Section A (Buildings). Section 3 lists the insured perils. Where a clause says so, the same peril also covers your **contents** under Section B (Section 8).

3.1 Escape of water Covered

3.1.1 **What is covered.** We cover sudden and accidental escape of water from fixed installations or appliances in your **home**, and the damage it causes to your **dwelling** and your **contents**.

3.1.2 **Examples of what §3.1 covers.** These are examples of sudden and accidental escape of water:

- a pipe that bursts, including a pipe that bursts because it froze
- a split or detached hose on a dishwasher or washing machine
- an appliance that leaks or overflows during a cycle
- a tank or cistern that fails or overflows

Water that spreads from the source into other rooms, or through a ceiling to the floor below, is included.

3.1.3 **Where §3.1 does not apply.** Section 3.1 does not cover water that has leaked or seeped gradually over a period of 14 days or more. That damage is excluded under §4.3 (Gradual leakage exclusion). Section 3.1 also does not cover damage while your **home** is **unoccupied** (see §4.5).

3.1.4 **Trace and access.** If an escape of water covered by §3.1 damages your **home**, we also pay the reasonable cost of **trace and access**: finding where the water is escaping from, and making good the floors, walls and ceilings that had to be opened. This is subject to the limit in §7.4. We do not pay for **trace and access** where the damage is excluded, for example under §4.3.

3.1.5 **Frozen pipes.** A pipe, tank or radiator that splits or bursts because the water in it froze is a sudden and accidental escape of water under §3.1. This applies whether or not the heating was on. If your **home** was left empty in cold weather, the precautions in §10.5 apply.

3.1.6 **The part that failed.** Section 3.1 covers the damage that the escaping water causes. It does not cover the cost of repairing or replacing the pipe, hose, seal, valve or **appliance** that failed, unless the failed part is itself damaged by an insured peril (see §4.7).

3.1.7 **Metered water.** If an escape of water covered by §3.1 increases your metered water charge, we pay the extra charge, subject to the limit in §7.4.

3.1.8 **Water from a neighbouring property.** We also cover sudden and accidental escape of water from a **fixed water installation** or **appliance** in a neighbouring property that enters your **home**. The same conditions and exclusions apply as for water escaping inside your **home**. If the neighbour or their insurer is responsible, we may recover our costs from them (§10.11).

3.2 Storm Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** and **contents** caused by **storm**. This includes wind of at least 90 km/h, torrential rain or hail, and the damage they cause directly. We do not cover damage to fences, gates or hedges under §3.2.

3.2.1 **Rain entering during a storm.** Rain that enters your **home** during a **storm**, through an opening the **storm** made, is covered under §3.2. For example, wind lifts roof tiles and rain comes through the ceiling.

3.2.2 **Roof leaks that are not storm damage.** Water that comes through a roof, gutter or flashing because it is worn, blocked or poorly maintained is not **storm** damage. It is excluded under §4.1 (Wear and tear) or §4.10 (Storm and flood exclusions), even if it is discovered after a storm.

3.3 Fire Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** and **contents** caused by fire, lightning, explosion or smoke. We do not cover scorching or smoke damage from cooking, candles or an open fire unless a fire broke out.

3.3.1 **Smoke.** Smoke damage is covered when it comes from a sudden and accidental fire or from a fault in a heating appliance. We do not cover smoke damage that builds up over time, such as from smoking, candles or an open fire.

3.4 Theft Covered

We cover loss of, or damage to, your **dwelling** and **contents** caused by theft or attempted theft. For §3.4 to apply, there must be forcible and violent entry into or exit from your **home**, and the theft must be reported to the police within 48 hours of discovery.

3.4.1 **Theft from outbuildings.** Theft of **contents** from **outbuildings** is covered only where there is forcible and violent entry into or exit from the **outbuilding**. The limit in §7.5 applies.

3.5 Flood Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** and **contents** caused by **flood**. We do not cover damage caused by groundwater rising from below (see §4.4), by the sea eroding the land, or to fences, gates, hedges, lawns and gardens. Water escaping from a **fixed water installation** or **appliance** inside your **home** is not **flood**; it is dealt with under §3.1.

3.6 Subsidence, heave and landslip Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** caused by **subsidence**, **heave** or **landslip** of the site on which your **home** stands. This cover does not include:

- damage to patios, paths, drives, walls, fences and gates, unless the main house is damaged at the same time and by the same cause
- the normal settlement, shrinkage or expansion of new structures, or of structures less than 12 months old
- damage caused by building work, demolition or repairs at your **home**
- damage caused by coastal or river erosion
- damage caused by the ground under your **home** being made up or filled in, or by poor foundations (see §4.6)

Water escaping from a **fixed water installation** that washes away or softens the ground under your **home** is assessed under §3.1 if the escape was sudden and accidental, and is excluded under §4.3 if it was **gradual leakage**.

3.7 Escape of oil Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** and **contents** caused by oil escaping suddenly and accidentally from a fixed heating installation or its tank. We also pay for the oil that is lost. We do not cover oil that escapes gradually, or damage to the tank or pipe that failed.

3.8 Impact Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** and **contents** caused by an aircraft or anything dropped from one, a road vehicle, a train, or an animal, colliding with your **home**. We do not cover damage caused by pets, or by a vehicle that you or your **family** own or drive.

3.9 Falling trees, branches, aerials and satellite dishes Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** and **contents** caused by a falling tree or branch, or a falling aerial, satellite dish, lamp post or telegraph pole. We pay to remove the part of the tree that caused the damage, but not the stump or roots. We do not cover damage to the aerial or dish itself, or damage caused by cutting down or lopping trees.

3.10 Riot, civil commotion and malicious damage Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** and **contents** caused by riot, civil commotion, strikers or people acting maliciously. We do not cover malicious damage by you, your **family**, your lodgers or tenants, or damage while your **home** is **unoccupied** (see §4.5).

3.11 Earthquake Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** and **contents** caused by earthquake.

3.12 Accidental breakage of fixed glass and sanitary ware Covered

We cover the cost of replacing fixed glass in windows, doors and skylights, and fixed baths, shower trays, shower screens, washbasins, sinks, toilet pans and cisterns, when they are broken suddenly and accidentally. This covers the item that breaks. Water that escapes because the item broke is assessed under §3.1. We do not cover chipping, scratching or cracks that develop over time. Section 3.12 does not cover **sealant and grouting**, which is dealt with under §4.8.

3.13 Accidental damage to underground services Covered

We cover accidental damage to **underground services**, including a pipe that is fractured or crushed. We do not cover pipes or cables that are worn, corroded or blocked, or that fail because they were badly laid (see §4.1 and §4.6). The limit in §7.4 applies.

3.14 Alternative accommodation Covered

If your **home** cannot be lived in because of damage covered by this policy, we pay the reasonable cost of alternative accommodation for you, your **family** and your pets, until your **home** can be lived in again. This includes the cost of storing your **contents**. The limit in §7.4 applies. We only pay these costs with our agreement in advance, except in an **emergency**.

3.15 Professional fees, debris removal and building regulations Covered

When we pay a claim for damage to your **dwelling**, we also pay:

- the reasonable fees of architects, surveyors and engineers needed to repair the damage
- the cost of removing debris and making the site safe
- the extra cost of meeting building regulations or local authority requirements when the damaged part is repaired

We do not pay fees for preparing a claim, or the cost of meeting a requirement that you had been told about before the damage happened.

3.16 Emergency access Covered

We cover damage to your **dwelling** caused by the fire, police or ambulance services forcing entry to your **home** in an **emergency** involving you or a risk of damage to your **home**. The limit in §7.4 applies.

3.17 Accidental damage (optional) Optional

Accidental damage is not an insured peril under Section 3 unless your **schedule** shows that you have added it. When you have, it is set out in §9.1 for your **dwelling** and §9.2 for your **contents**. Without it, damage that is accidental but not caused by an insured peril in §3.1 to §3.16 is not covered.

SECTION 4

Buildings exclusions (Section A)

The exclusions in this section apply to every insured peril in Section 3, unless the clause says otherwise. They also apply to your **contents** under Section B where Section 8 says so. The general exclusions in Section 11 apply as well.

4.1 Wear and tear Excluded

We do not cover wear and tear, gradual deterioration, rust, corrosion or the natural ageing of any part of your **home** or **contents**. Section 4.1 excludes the deterioration itself. It does not exclude sudden and accidental damage that the deterioration causes. For example, if a worn hose splits suddenly, the resulting water damage is assessed under §3.1.

Water damage that builds up over time, from a slow leak or from water getting past failed **sealant and grouting**, is dealt with under §4.3 (Gradual leakage exclusion), not under §4.1.

4.2 Deliberate damage by you Excluded

We do not cover loss or damage caused deliberately by you, or by anyone living in your **home** with your permission.

4.3 Gradual leakage exclusion Excluded

We do not cover damage from water leaking or seeping gradually over a period of 14 days or more, from any source. This exclusion includes:

- water escaping past failed seals or grouting around a shower, shower tray, bath, sink or toilet
- slow leaks from pipes, joints or fittings
- rot, mould, decay or subfloor damage that results from any of the above

Section 4.3 applies whether or not you were aware of the leak. It applies even though the water came from a **fixed water installation** or **appliance**. Damage of this kind is not sudden and accidental and is not covered under §3.1.

Floors and ceilings weakened by a gradual leak. If a floor, ceiling, joist or subfloor gives way, sags or becomes soft because it was weakened by **gradual leakage**, that damage is part of the gradual damage and is also excluded under §4.3. This applies even when you only notice the damage on one day.

How we decide whether §4.3 applies. The date you discover the damage is not the date the leak started. To decide how long water has been escaping, our **adjuster** looks at evidence such as rot or decay in timber, mould growth, staining and tide marks, corrosion around fittings, the condition of **sealant and grouting**, and the report of any **contractor** who opened up the floor or wall. A **contractor's** statement that a leak has been going on for weeks or months is strong evidence that §4.3 applies.

4.4 Rising groundwater Excluded

We do not cover damage caused by groundwater rising, or by a change in the water table beneath your **home**.

4.5 Unoccupied home Excluded

We do not cover loss or damage that happens while your **home** has been **unoccupied** for more than 60 days in a row. Section 4.5 applies from day 61 until someone lives in the **home** again.

Section 4.5 applies to escape of water, theft, malicious damage and accidental breakage of glass and sanitary ware. It still applies if you turned off the water or visited the **home** during the day without staying overnight. If you tell us in advance that your **home** will be **unoccupied** (§10.2), we may agree in writing to continue some cover, on conditions we set.

4.6 Defective workmanship, design or materials Excluded

We do not cover the cost of putting right **defective workmanship**, faulty design or faulty materials, whoever did the work. For example, we do not pay to relay a pipe that was badly joined, or to rebuild a floor that was not built to support its load. Section 4.6 excludes the cost of correcting the fault itself. Sudden and accidental damage that the fault causes is assessed under the insured peril that caused it, for example §3.1 when a badly fitted joint suddenly comes apart. Water that seeps gradually because of poor work is excluded under §4.3.

4.7 The part that failed Excluded

We do not cover the cost of repairing or replacing the pipe, hose, valve, seal, tank, boiler or **appliance** that caused an escape of water, if it failed because of wear, a mechanical or electrical fault, or **defective workmanship**. We do cover the damage the escaping water causes (§3.1), the cost of finding the leak (§3.1.4), and a pipe or tank that split because it froze (§3.1.5).

4.8 Seals, grouting and sealant maintenance Excluded

We do not cover the cost of replacing or renewing **sealant and grouting** around a bath, shower, shower tray, sink, toilet or tiled surface. Keeping **sealant and grouting** in good condition is part of maintaining your **home** (§10.1). Damage caused by water that escapes past failed **sealant and grouting** is excluded under §4.3 (Gradual leakage exclusion).

4.9 Condensation, damp and mould Excluded

We do not cover damage caused by condensation, rising damp, poor ventilation, or damp that comes through walls, floors or roofs. We do not cover mould, fungus or rot unless it is caused by damage we cover, such as a sudden escape of water under §3.1. Mould or rot that results from **gradual leakage** is excluded under §4.3.

4.10 Storm and flood exclusions Excluded

Under §3.2 (Storm) and §3.5 (Flood), we do not cover:

- damage to fences, gates, hedges, lawns, plants or garden structures
- damage caused by frost, unless the frost caused an escape of water under §3.1.5
- rain, snow or water that gets into your **home** through a worn, blocked or badly maintained roof, gutter, downpipe, window or door, when no **storm** made an opening
- damage to swimming pools, hot tubs, and their covers

4.11 Subsidence exclusions Excluded

The limits on §3.6 (Subsidence, heave and landslip) are set out in that clause. We also do not cover **subsidence** damage that was already happening before the **period of insurance** began (see §11.5), or damage for which compensation is provided under a contract or by law.

4.12 Theft exclusions for buildings Excluded

Under §3.4 (Theft), we do not cover theft or attempted theft by you, your **family**, your lodgers or tenants, or anyone you allowed into your **home**. We do not cover theft where there was no forcible and violent entry or exit, or theft from an unlocked **outbuilding**.

4.13 Pets, insects and vermin Excluded

We do not cover damage caused by pets, insects, vermin, birds or wild animals chewing, scratching, tearing or fouling. We do cover fire or escape of water that they cause, under §3.3 or §3.1.

4.14 Building works, alterations and repairs Excluded

We do not cover damage caused while your **home** is being built, extended, altered, renovated or repaired, if the damage is caused by that work. We also do not cover damage to the part of the **dwelling** being worked on. Tell us before you start major works (§10.6).

4.15 Loss of value Excluded

We do not cover any fall in the market value of your **home** after it has been repaired, or loss of value because it has had a claim. We also do not cover the cost of replacing undamaged parts of your **home** to make them match repaired parts, except as set out in §13.7.

SECTION 5

Deductibles

5.1 **Deductible by product.** For each claim, you pay the first part of the claim, called the **deductible**:

- **Homeowners Standard:** EUR 250 per claim.
- **Homeowners Plus:** EUR 500 per claim.

Your **schedule** confirms which product you hold.

5.2 **How the deductible is applied.** We take the **deductible** off the amount we agree to pay. If one incident damages both your **dwelling** and your **contents**, only one **deductible** applies.

5.3 **Claims below the deductible.** If the agreed amount of a claim is less than or equal to your **deductible**, we make no payment.

5.4 **Emergency costs and the deductible.** The reasonable cost of emergency measures you take to limit damage covered by this policy (§6.2) forms part of your claim. It is added to the rest of the claim before we take off the **deductible**.

5.5 **Optional covers and the deductible.** The **deductible** for your product also applies to claims under the optional covers in Section 9, unless your **schedule** says otherwise.

5.6 **One incident across two periods.** If damage from one incident continues from one **period of insurance** into the next, we treat it as one claim and apply one **deductible**, using the product that was in force when the incident began.

SECTION 6

Claims conditions

You must meet these conditions for us to pay a claim.

6.1 **Report within 30 days.** You must tell us about any loss or damage as soon as possible, and in any case within 30 days of the date it happened. We may refuse or reduce a claim reported after 30 days if the delay has made the damage worse or harder for us to assess.

6.2 **Mitigate further damage.** You must take reasonable steps to prevent further damage. For an escape of water, this means turning off the water supply at the stopcock or the appliance, calling a plumber, and moving **contents** away from the water where it is safe to do so. We pay the reasonable cost of emergency measures taken to limit damage covered by this policy. We do not pay for further damage caused because these steps were not taken.

6.3 **Give us information.** You must give us a completed Home Claim Notification Form, and any estimates, invoices, photos or reports that we reasonably ask for.

6.4 **Keep damaged items.** You must keep damaged items and parts until we have had the chance to inspect them. This includes the failed hose, pipe or seal.

6.5 **Inspection.** You must allow us, or an adjuster we appoint, to inspect your **home** and the damage. We may inspect before or after emergency repairs, and we may ask a **contractor** to open up floors or walls to see the cause and extent of the damage.

6.6 **One claim per incident.** You must make one claim for each incident. If you have already claimed for an incident, you must not claim for the same loss again.

6.7 **Theft and malicious damage.** For theft, attempted theft or malicious damage, you must report the incident to the police within 48 hours of discovering it, get a crime reference number, and give it to us.

6.8 **Repairs before we agree.** You may carry out emergency repairs straight away to protect your **home** (§6.2). Apart from emergency repairs, you must not start permanent repairs or dispose of damaged items until we agree, unless we have not responded within 10 working days of receiving your Home Claim Notification Form.

6.9 **Proof of ownership and value.** You must give us reasonable evidence of the ownership, age and value of any item you claim for, such as receipts, bank statements, instruction booklets, photos or valuations. For items bought in the last 12 months, we will usually ask for a receipt or bank record.

6.10 **Working with our adjuster.** You must give our **adjuster** reasonable access to your **home**, answer their questions honestly, and tell them about any earlier damage or repairs in the affected area.

6.11 **Admitting liability.** If a claim involves someone else, you must not admit fault, or offer or agree to pay anything, without our written permission. You must send us, unopened, any letter or legal document you receive about the claim.

6.12 **Our right to act in your name.** We may take over and conduct, in your name, the defence or settlement of any claim, or take action in your name to recover what we have paid from anyone responsible for the damage (§10.11).

6.13 **If you do not meet these conditions.** If you do not meet a condition in this section, and that affects our ability to assess or handle the claim, we may reduce the amount we pay or, in serious cases, refuse the claim. We will tell you which condition was not met.

SECTION 7

Limits

7.1 **Limits per the schedule.** The most we will pay for any one claim is:

- for damage to your **dwelling**, the **dwelling limit** shown in your **schedule**
- for damage to your **contents**, the **contents limit** shown in your **schedule**

7.2 **Limits apply separately.** The **dwelling limit** and **contents limit** apply separately. If one incident damages both, each part is paid up to its own limit.

7.3 **Deductible first.** We apply the **deductible** (Section 5) before we apply the limits in §7.1.

7.4 **Buildings sub-limits.** These limits apply within your **dwelling limit**, for any one claim:

- **trace and access** (§3.1.4): EUR 5,000
- metered water charges (§3.1.7): EUR 1,000
- **underground services** (§3.13): EUR 5,000
- alternative accommodation (§3.14): 20% of your **dwelling limit**
- emergency access (§3.16): EUR 1,000

7.5 **Contents sub-limits.** These limits apply within your **contents limit**, for any one claim:

- **valuables** in total: one third of your **contents limit**
- any **single article** of **valuables**, or any work of art: EUR 2,000, unless it is listed in your **schedule**
- **money** (§8.5): EUR 500
- misuse of credit and debit cards (§8.5): EUR 1,000
- food in freezers (§8.6): EUR 500
- **contents** in **outbuildings** (§8.4): EUR 2,500
- **contents** in the open within the boundary of your **home** (§8.4): EUR 1,000
- belongings of guests and domestic employees (§8.7): EUR 1,000
- students' belongings away from home (§8.8): EUR 2,500
- replacement locks and keys (§8.9): EUR 1,000
- documents and deeds (§8.12): EUR 500

7.6 **Single article limit.** Apart from **valuables** and items listed in your **schedule**, the most we pay for any **single article** of **contents** is EUR 2,000. See §8.11.

7.7 **Personal possessions limits.** If your **schedule** shows personal possessions cover (§9.4), the most we pay for any one claim is EUR 5,000, and EUR 1,500 for any **single article**, unless a higher limit is shown in your **schedule**.

7.8 **Underinsurance.** Your **dwelling limit** must be enough to rebuild your **home** in full, and your **contents limit** must be enough to replace all your **contents** as new. If, at the time of the loss, a limit is less than 85% of the full amount, we may reduce what we pay in the same proportion. For example, if your **contents limit** is 60% of the true replacement value, we may pay 60% of your **contents** claim.

SECTION 8

Contents cover (Section B)

Section 8 is Section B (Contents). It covers your **contents** while they are in your **home**, unless a clause says otherwise.

8.1 Covered **What Section B covers.** We cover your **contents** against loss or damage caused by the insured perils in §3.1 to §3.11 (escape of water, storm, fire, theft, flood, subsidence, escape of oil, impact, falling trees, riot and malicious damage, and earthquake). The exclusions in Section 4, as they apply to those perils, and the general exclusions in Section 11 also apply to your **contents**.

8.2 Covered

Escape of water and your contents. When a sudden and accidental escape of water is covered under §3.1, we also cover your **contents** that the water damages, such as carpets, rugs, furniture and electrical goods. **Contents** damaged by water that leaked or seeped gradually over 14 days or more are not covered; §4.3 (Gradual leakage exclusion) applies to **contents** in the same way as to your **dwelling**.

8.3 Covered

Contents temporarily away from your home. We cover your **contents** while they are temporarily in another private house, a bank, a safe deposit, or a building where you are working or staying, anywhere in Ireland, against the insured perils in §3.1 to §3.11. Theft is covered only if there was forcible and violent entry into or exit from the building. We do not cover **contents** away from your **home** for more than 60 days in a row, or **contents** in a removal van or storage unit, unless we have agreed in writing.

8.4 Covered

Contents in outbuildings and in the open. We cover **contents** in your **outbuildings**, and garden furniture, plants in pots and other **contents** in the open within the boundary of your **home**, against the insured perils in §3.1 to §3.11. The limits in §7.5 apply. We do not cover **money** or **valuables** kept in **outbuildings**.

8.5 Covered

Money and credit cards. We cover **money** in your **home** against the insured perils in §3.1 to §3.11, and your liability for the misuse of your credit, debit or bank cards after they are lost or stolen, provided you tell the card issuer as soon as you discover the loss. The limits in §7.5 apply.

8.6 Covered

Food in freezers. We cover food in a freezer or fridge in your **home** that spoils because of a rise or fall in temperature caused by a breakdown or by the power supply failing. We do not cover spoilage when the power supply was cut off deliberately, or when the freezer is more than 10 years old. The limit in §7.5 applies.

8.7 Covered

Belongings of guests and domestic employees. We cover the belongings of your guests and of domestic employees who live with you, while they are in your **home**, against the insured perils in §3.1 to §3.11. The limit in §7.5 applies. We do not cover them if they are insured elsewhere.

8.8 Covered

Students' belongings. We cover the belongings of a member of your **family** who is in full-time education and lives away from home during term, against the insured perils in §3.1 to §3.11, while in their term-time residence in Ireland. Theft is covered only if there was forcible and violent entry into or exit from the residence. The limit in §7.5 applies.

8.9 Covered

Replacement locks and keys. If the keys to the external doors of your **home**, or to a safe or alarm, are lost or stolen, we pay the cost of replacing the locks or lock mechanisms. The limit in §7.5 applies.

8.10 Covered

Valuables. Valuables are covered in your **home** against the insured perils in §3.1 to §3.11. The limits in §7.5 apply. Any **single article** of **valuables** worth more than EUR 2,000 must be listed in your **schedule**, with a valuation or receipt less than three years old. Otherwise, the most we pay for it is EUR 2,000. Outside your **home**, **valuables** are covered only under personal possessions cover (§9.4), if your **schedule** shows it.

8.11 Limit

Single article limit. The most we pay for any **single article** of **contents** that is not **valuables** is EUR 2,000, unless it is listed in your **schedule**. A **pair or set** counts as one **single article**. A three-piece suite, for example, counts as one article.

8.12 Covered

Documents and personal data. If documents, deeds, passports or certificates in your **home** are lost or damaged by an insured peril, we pay the cost of replacing them or of the blank material and the work needed to rewrite them. We do not pay for their value as documents. The limit in §7.5 applies.

8.13 Electrical and mechanical breakdown Excluded

We do not cover the breakdown of electrical or electronic equipment, or of any **appliance**, or the cost of repairing it, unless the breakdown was caused by an insured peril. For example, a television damaged by water from a burst pipe is covered under §3.1 and §8.2. A television that stops working because of an internal fault is not covered.

8.14 Wear, cleaning and light Excluded

We do not cover loss or damage to **contents** caused by **wear and tear**, moths, cleaning, washing, repairing, restoring, dyeing, or exposure to light. Where **contents** are damaged by water that escaped gradually, §4.3 applies.

8.15 Contents in an unoccupied home Excluded

We do not cover loss or damage to **contents** that happens while your **home** has been **unoccupied** for more than 60 days in a row (§4.5).

8.16 Business property Excluded

We do not cover property held or used for **business use**, stock, samples, or equipment you use mainly for work, unless we have agreed in writing and your **schedule** shows it. A computer you use for work at home is covered as **contents** if you own it.

8.17 Vehicles, boats and their parts Excluded

We do not cover motor vehicles, electric scooters, caravans, trailers, boats, aircraft or drones, or their parts, keys and accessories. We do cover electric wheelchairs, mobility scooters, ride-on lawnmowers and children's toys.

8.18 Pets and living things Excluded

We do not cover animals, birds or fish, or plants and trees in the ground.

SECTION 9

Optional covers

The covers in this section apply only if your **schedule** shows them. The **deductible** in Section 5 and the limits in Section 7 apply to each of them.

9.1 Accidental damage to your dwelling Optional

If your **schedule** shows accidental damage cover for your **dwelling**, we cover **accidental damage** to your **dwelling**, as well as the insured perils in Section 3. For example, putting a foot through a ceiling while in the loft, or drilling through a pipe or cable. This cover does not change §4.3: water that escapes gradually is not **accidental damage**.

9.2 Accidental damage to your contents Optional

If your **schedule** shows accidental damage cover for your **contents**, we cover **accidental damage** to your **contents** in your **home**. For example, spilling paint on a carpet, or dropping a television. Water escaping from a **fixed water installation** or **appliance** is dealt with under §3.1 and §8.2, not under §9.2.

9.3 What accidental damage cover does not include Excluded

Under §9.1 and §9.2 we do not cover:

- damage caused by **wear and tear**, **gradual leakage**, damp, condensation or mould
- damage caused by **defective workmanship**, faulty design or faulty materials
- damage from any work to alter, repair, clean, maintain or decorate your **home** or **contents**
- chewing, scratching, tearing or fouling by pets
- breakdown of electrical or mechanical equipment (§8.13)
- damage while your **home** is let, or **unoccupied** for more than 60 days (§4.5)
- damage to mobile phones, laptops, tablets, glasses, contact lenses or clothing, unless personal possessions cover (§9.4) applies
- damage that is deliberate, or caused by someone you let into your **home**

9.4 Personal possessions away from your home Optional

If your **schedule** shows personal possessions cover, we cover your **personal possessions** against loss, theft or **accidental damage**, anywhere in the world, for up to 60 days in a row outside Ireland in any **period of insurance**. The limits in §7.7 apply.

9.5 What personal possessions cover does not include Excluded

Under §9.4 we do not cover:

- items left unattended in a public place, or in an unlocked vehicle
- items in a vehicle that are visible from outside, or theft from a vehicle at night
- sports equipment while it is being used
- **money**, tickets and travel documents, unless your **schedule** shows them
- items sent by post, carrier or airline as luggage, unless in your control
- scratching, denting or cosmetic damage that does not stop an item working
- **wear and tear**, breakdown, or gradual deterioration

9.6 How optional covers work with the rest of the policy

An optional cover adds to Sections 3 and 8. It does not replace or change any other clause. If a loss is covered by an insured peril in Section 3 or Section 8, we deal with it under that clause first. An optional cover never overrides an exclusion in Section 4 or Section 11 unless the optional clause says so.

SECTION 10

General conditions

These conditions apply to the whole policy.

10.1 **Taking care of your home.** You must keep your **home** in a good state of repair. This includes maintaining seals, grouting and water connections.

10.2 **Telling us about changes.** You must tell us if your **home** will be **unoccupied** for more than 60 days, or if the information in your **schedule** changes.

You must also tell us before the start of the next **period of insurance**, or as soon as you can, if:

- you change your address
- anyone in your household is convicted of a criminal offence, other than a driving offence
- your **home** will be used for **business use**, or let to tenants or lodgers
- your **home** will undergo building work costing more than EUR 30,000

10.3 **Giving us correct information.** You must answer honestly and with reasonable care the questions we ask when you take out, change or renew this policy. If you do not, we may change the terms, reduce what we pay on a claim in proportion to the premium we would have charged, or, if the answer was dishonest or reckless, cancel the policy and refuse the claim.

10.4 **Home security.** You must lock all external doors and windows and set any alarm when your **home** is left empty. If a theft happens when a lock or alarm we asked you to fit was not in use, we may refuse the theft claim.

10.5 **Protecting your home in cold weather.** If your **home** will be left empty for more than 7 days in a row between 1 November and 31 March, you must either keep the heating on at a continuous minimum of 12°C, or turn off the water at the stopcock and drain the system. If an escape of water happens because you did not do this, we may reduce or refuse the claim. Section 10.5 does not change §4.5, which applies after 60 days whatever precautions you took.

10.6 **Building works.** You must tell us before you start building work at your **home** that costs more than EUR 30,000, or that involves structural alterations, a new roof, or removing internal walls. We may change the terms of your policy while the work is carried out.

10.7 **Joint policyholders.** Where there is more than one policyholder, each of you must meet the terms of this policy. Anything one of you tells us, or agrees with us, applies to all of you. We may pay a claim to any of you.

10.8 **Paying your premium.** You must pay your premium when it is due. If you pay by instalments and miss a payment, we will write to you. If the payment is still not made within 14 days, we may cancel the policy (§15.3).

10.9 **Law and language.** This policy is governed by the law of Ireland, and the courts of Ireland have jurisdiction. We will communicate with you in English.

10.10 **Other insurance.** If another insurance policy also covers the same loss, we pay only our proportionate share. You must tell us about any other insurance that covers your **home** or **contents** when you make a claim.

10.11 **Our right to recover costs.** After we pay a claim, we may take action in your name to recover what we paid from anyone responsible for the loss, such as a neighbour whose installation leaked (§3.1.8) or a **contractor** whose work was defective. You must help us with this, at our cost.

SECTION 11

General exclusions

These exclusions apply to every section of this policy, including the optional covers.

11.1 Excluded **War.** We do not cover loss or damage caused by war, invasion, act of a foreign enemy, hostilities, civil war, rebellion, revolution, military or usurped power.

11.2 Excluded **Terrorism.** We do not cover loss or damage caused by **terrorism**, or by any action taken to control, prevent or respond to it.

11.3 Excluded **Nuclear risks.** We do not cover loss or damage caused by ionising radiation, radioactive contamination, or the radioactive, toxic or explosive properties of any nuclear material.

11.4 Excluded **Pressure waves.** We do not cover loss or damage caused by pressure waves from aircraft or other aerial devices travelling at or above the speed of sound.

11.5 Excluded **Loss before your cover started.** We do not cover any loss that happened before the **period of insurance** started. Where damage builds up over time, it is treated as having happened when it began, not when it was discovered.

11.6 Excluded **Indirect loss.** We do not cover any loss or cost that is not directly caused by the event that led to the claim, such as loss of earnings, time off work, or inconvenience, unless the policy says otherwise (for example §3.14).

11.7 Excluded **Electronic data and cyber.** We do not cover loss of, or damage to, data or software, or loss caused by a computer virus, hacking or the failure of any computer system to work as intended. Physical damage to a computer caused by an insured peril is covered as **contents**.

11.8 Excluded **Pollution and contamination.** We do not cover loss or damage caused by pollution or contamination, unless it is caused by a sudden and accidental event covered by this policy, such as escape of oil (§3.7).

11.9 Excluded **Infectious disease.** We do not cover loss, cost or cleaning caused by an infectious or contagious disease, or by fear of one.

11.10 Excluded **Confiscation.** We do not cover loss or damage caused by confiscation, requisition or destruction by order of any government, public or local authority.

11.11 Excluded **Deliberate and criminal acts.** We do not cover loss or damage caused deliberately or through a criminal act by you, your **family**, or anyone living in your **home** (see also §4.2).

11.12 Excluded **Business use.** We do not cover loss or damage arising from **business use** of your **home** unless we have agreed to it in writing and it is shown in your **schedule**.

SECTION 12

How to make a claim

12.1 **In an emergency.** First make your **home** safe and stop the damage getting worse. For an escape of water, turn off the water at the stopcock or the **appliance**, switch off the electricity if water is near sockets or lights, call a plumber, and move **contents** away from the water where it is safe to do so (§6.2). Keep the invoice for any emergency work.

12.2 **Tell us.** Contact us as soon as you can, and in any case within 30 days of the loss or damage (§6.1), using the claims contact details in your **schedule**. Have your policy number ready.

12.3 **Complete the Home Claim Notification Form.** We will ask you to complete the Home Claim Notification Form (§6.3). It asks for your policy and property details, when and how the damage happened and was discovered, the cause, what you did to limit the damage, a list of damaged **contents**, a summary of any **contractor's** estimate, your previous claims, and the bank details we should pay into. Please answer every question. If you do not know an answer, say so.

12.4 **What to send with your form.** Please send, where you have them:

- photos or video of the damage, and of the cause, such as the failed hose or pipe
- a **contractor's** written estimate for the repairs
- invoices for emergency work
- receipts, bank records or other proof of ownership for damaged **contents** (§6.9)
- any report from a plumber or **contractor** about the cause of the damage
- a crime reference number, for theft or malicious damage (§6.7)

12.5 **Registration and triage.** When we receive your claim, we register it and check it against this policy wording. Some claims are accepted straight away. Others are referred to one of our adjusters, who makes the decision.

12.6 **Our decision.** Our adjuster may accept your claim, accept part of it, or decline it. We will tell you which clause of this policy wording our decision is based on.

12.7 **Emergency and temporary repairs.** You may arrange emergency repairs straight away. We pay the reasonable cost of emergency work to limit damage covered by this policy (§6.2). Keep any damaged parts you remove (§6.4). Permanent repairs should wait until we agree (§6.8).

12.8 **If someone else caused the damage.** If you think a neighbour, landlord, **contractor** or anyone else caused the damage, tell us their name and address on your Home Claim Notification Form. Do not admit fault or agree anything with them (§6.11). We may recover our costs from them (§10.11).

12.9 **If more than one incident has happened.** Make one claim for each incident (§6.6). If you have claimed before for damage in the same room or from the same source, tell us on your form, with the date and the claim number if you have it.

SECTION 13

How we settle claims

13.1 **Repair or replace.** We may pay to repair or replace the damaged item, or we may pay you the cost of doing so. We will not pay more than it would cost us to repair or replace the item with one of similar quality.

13.2 **Your dwelling.** For damage to your **dwelling**, we pay the reasonable cost of repairing the damage to the same standard and in the same style as before, using a **contractor** we approve or one you choose with our agreement. If a **contractor** we appoint carries out the repair, we guarantee the workmanship for 12 months.

13.3 **If you do not repair your dwelling.** If you decide not to repair the damage, or if the repair is not carried out without delay, we pay the reduction in the market value of your **home** caused by the damage, but not more than the cost of repair.

13.4 **Contents: new for old.** For **contents**, we replace the item with a new one of similar quality, or pay you what it would cost us to do so, with no deduction for age. If an item can be repaired economically, we pay the cost of repair instead. New for old does not apply to clothing and household linen (§13.5).

13.5 **Clothing and household linen.** For clothing and household linen, such as towels and bedding, we take off an amount for **wear and tear** based on the age and condition of the item.

13.6 **Pairs, sets and suites.** If an item that is part of a **pair or set** is lost or damaged, we pay for that item only. If a matching replacement is not available, we pay up to 50% of the cost of replacing the undamaged items so that they match. A three-piece suite, for example: if only the sofa is damaged, we pay for the sofa, and may contribute towards the chairs.

13.7 **Matching floors, tiles and kitchen units.** We pay to repair or replace flooring, tiles or fitted units in the room or area that was damaged. We do not pay to replace undamaged flooring, tiles or units in other rooms, or in an open-plan area beyond a natural break such as a doorway or threshold, so that they match. If a matching replacement is not available for the damaged area, we pay up to 50% of the cost of replacing the undamaged part of the same room.

13.8 **Betterment.** If a repair or replacement leaves your property better than it was just before the damage, we may ask you to pay a contribution for the **betterment**. We do not ask for a contribution for new for old replacement of **contents** (§13.4), or where a repair has to meet building regulations (§3.15).

13.9 **Cash settlement.** We may offer a cash payment instead of repair or replacement. If we can repair or replace at a discount through our own suppliers, a cash payment is limited to what it would have cost us.

13.10 **Paying you.** We pay by bank transfer into the account named on your Home Claim Notification Form. The account must be in the name of a policyholder, unless you ask us in writing to pay someone else, such as your **contractor**. We take off the **deductible** before we pay (§5.2).

13.11 **Salvage.** When we pay for an item in full, it belongs to us. We may take it away, or agree a reduced payment and let you keep it.

13.12 **VAT.** We include VAT in what we pay for repairs or replacements, where you are not able to recover it.

13.13 **After a claim.** After we pay a claim, your **dwelling limit** and **contents limit** go back to their full amounts, without any extra premium, provided you carry out any repairs we recommend.

SECTION 14

Complaints

14.1 **Tell us.** If you are unhappy with how we have handled your claim, contact Ardenfield Mutual Customer Relations. We will acknowledge your complaint within 5 working days.

14.2 **How we deal with your complaint.** We will give you the name of the person dealing with your complaint, and update you in writing at least every 20 working days. We aim to resolve your complaint within 40 working days of receiving it. If we cannot, we will tell you why, and when we expect to finish.

14.3 **Our final response.** When we finish, we will write to you with our final response. It will explain what we decided and why, and name the clause of this policy wording our decision is based on, where it relates to a claim.

14.4 **The Financial Services and Pensions Ombudsman.** If you are not satisfied with our final response, or we have not resolved your complaint within 40 working days, you can refer it to the Financial Services and Pensions Ombudsman. The Ombudsman is independent and its service is free. Our final response will explain how to contact it.

14.5 **Your other rights.** Making a complaint does not affect your right to take legal action.

SECTION 15

Cancellation

15.1 **Cooling-off period.** You may cancel this policy within 14 days of receiving it, or of the start of the **period of insurance**, whichever is later. If you do, and no claim has been made, we refund the full premium.

15.2 **Cancelling at any time.** You may cancel this policy at any time. If no claim has been made in the current **period of insurance**, we refund the premium for the unused period.

15.3 **Our right to cancel.** We may cancel this policy by giving you 14 days' notice in writing to your last known address, for a valid reason, such as not paying the premium (§10.8), not giving us correct information (§10.3), fraud (Section 18), or threatening or abusive behaviour towards our staff. If we cancel, we refund the premium for the unused period, unless the reason is fraud.

15.4 **Refunds after a claim.** If a claim has been made in the current **period of insurance**, we do not refund any premium when the policy is cancelled, and any instalments due for the rest of the **period of insurance** remain payable.

SECTION 16

Data protection

16.1 **Who we are.** Ardenfield Mutual is the controller of the personal information you give us about yourself and anyone else named on your policy or claim. When you give us information about another person, you must have their permission.

16.2 **What we collect.** We collect your name, contact details, address, date of birth, details of your **home**, your claims history, bank details for claim payments, and the information you give on a Home Claim Notification Form, including photos, estimates and invoices. We may collect information about criminal convictions where this is relevant to your insurance.

16.3 **How we use it.** We use your information to provide and administer your policy, to assess and pay claims, to prevent and detect fraud, to meet our legal and regulatory duties, and to improve our service. We use automated tools to register claims, check them against this policy wording and route them for review. An automated check never refuses or reduces a claim. Where a claim is referred, an **adjuster** makes the decision.

16.4 **Who we share it with.** We share your information, only as needed, with **adjusters**, **contractors** and suppliers who help us handle claims, other insurers and reinsurers, industry claims and anti-fraud databases, the police and regulators where the law requires it, and anyone you authorise to act for you.

16.5 **How long we keep it.** We keep your information for as long as your policy is in force and for up to 7 years after it ends or after a claim is closed, whichever is later, unless the law requires us to keep it longer.

16.6 **Your rights.** You have the right to see the personal information we hold about you, to have it corrected, to object to or restrict how we use it, to ask us to delete it where we no longer need it, and to receive a copy to give to another provider. You can ask for a person to review any decision made about you by automated means.

16.7 **Contact and complaints.** You can contact our Data Protection Officer at the address in your **schedule**. If you are unhappy with how we use your information, you can complain to the Data Protection Commission.

SECTION 17

Sanctions

17.1 **Sanctions.** We do not provide cover, pay any claim or provide any benefit under this policy to the extent that doing so would expose us to any sanction, prohibition or restriction under the resolutions of the United Nations, or the trade or economic sanctions, laws or regulations of the European Union, Ireland, the United Kingdom or the United States of America.

SECTION 18

Fraud

18.1 **Fraudulent claims.** If you, or anyone acting for you, make a claim that is fraudulent in any way, we will not pay it. This includes giving false information or false documents, hiding information that affects the claim, or causing loss or damage deliberately.

18.2 **Exaggerated claims.** If any part of a claim is exaggerated, for example by claiming for items that were not damaged, inflating the value of an item, or including damage that happened before the incident, we may refuse the whole claim.

18.3 **Fraudulent or duplicate claims.** If a claim is fraudulent, exaggerated, or repeats a loss we have already paid, we will not pay it, and we may cancel your policy. Claims on the same policy for similar losses close together in time may be referred for review before we deal with them.

18.4 **What we may do.** If a claim is fraudulent, we may:

- refuse the claim, and recover from you any amount we have already paid on it
- cancel your policy from the date of the fraud, and keep the premium
- refuse any later claim under this policy
- recover from you the reasonable costs of investigating the claim
- tell the police and share the details with industry anti-fraud databases

18.5 **Fraud checks.** To prevent and detect fraud, we check claims against our own records and industry databases, and we may compare a new claim with earlier claims on your policy. A claim referred for a fraud check is reviewed by a person before any decision is made.